

(c) 2,4,3,1

(d) 4,3,2,1

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) was correct. Present situation is as follows –

Major oilseeds	Production (Million Tonnes) 2023-24
Soybean	13.05
Groundnut	10.2
Sesamum	0.81
Rapeseed and Mustard	13.3

20. 'Varuna' is a variety of –

- (a) Mustard (b) Linseed
(c) Sunflower (d) Sesame

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

Mustard is an oilseed. Pusabold, Jaikisan, Varuna are the main varieties of Mustard.

21. 'Pusa Bold' is a variety of –

- (a) Wheat (b) Mustard
(c) Gram (d) Groundnut

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question

22. 'Pitambari' is a variety of

- (a) Paddy (b) Gram
(c) Mustard (d) Wheat

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Pitambari (RYSK - 05-02) is a variety of Yellow Mustard. Maturity period of Pitambari Mustard is 110-115 days while average production is 1536 kg/per hectare.

23. A large quantity of gypsum is required for –

- (a) Rice cultivation (b) Barseem cultivation
(c) Wheat cultivation (d) Groundnut cultivation

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

A large quantity of gypsum is required for Groundnut cultivation.

24. 'Kaushal' is an improved variety of –

- (a) Gram (b) Cotton
(c) Groundnut (d) Wheat

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (c)

(Crop)	(Varieties)
Gram	– Pant-114, Gaurav, Radhe, K-4
Cotton	– Suvin, Sujata, Desi Shyamli
Groundnut	– Chitra-64, Chandra, Kaushal
Wheat	– Kundan, Kalyan Sona, Sonalika

25. Which of the following crop has the highest percentage of oil content?

- (a) Groundnut (b) Soyabean
(c) Sunflower (d) Sesame

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

Crop	Oil content
Groundnut	48.2%
Soyabean	40%
Sunflower	42%
Sesame	52%

26. 'Safflower' is a oil seed crop. Its scientific name is:

- (a) Glycine max
(b) Ricinus Communis
(c) Carthamus Tinctorius
(d) Bunchy top

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

The scientific name of 'Safflower' is Carthamus Tinctorius. The Seed contain 24-36% oil. Maharashtra and Karnataka are major safflower growing states. The oil is as good as sunflower oil having a sufficient amount of linoleic acid (78%), which is very useful for reducing blood cholesterol.

Pulses

*Pulses are a major source of protein in India. The major pulse crops of India are **gram, urad, green gram, mash, tur, lentils** etc. These crops have the capacity of **nitrogen fixation** from the air. **Cobalt** is known to be essential for symbiotic nitrogen fixation by Rhizobium. Cobalt is also needed in the synthesis of vitamin B₁₂.

*According to data of the Economic Survey 2024-25, in the year 2023-24, the largest producer of total pulses in India is Madhya Pradesh which is followed by Maharashtra (2nd) and Rajasthan (3rd).

Malviya chamtkar is a species of tur dal. Other species are **Amar, Aajad, Bahar, Malviya vikash, MA6, Paras** etc.

*Most productive state of gram in India is **Madhya Pradesh**. The NPK ratio for Pulse crop is 0 : 1 : 1, 1 : 2 : 2 or 1 : 2 : 3.

1. With reference to pulse production in India, consider the following statements:
 1. Black gram can be cultivated as both kharif and rabi crop.
 2. Green-gram alone accounts for nearly half of pulse production.
 3. In the last three decades, while the production of kharif pulses has increased, the production of rabi pulses has decreased.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Urad is tropical climate crop, it is a kharif crop in North India and both Rabi and Kharif season crop in South India. Production of Moong in the year 2016-17 is 14 of the total pulses. The percentage remains around the same in other years also. Hence, Statement 2 is false. In the last three decades, there has been a marginal [negligible] increase in the production of Kharif crops, which that of Rabi pulses has increased by about 150 percent. Hence, Statement 3 is also false.

2. Which one of the following countries is the major producer and consumer of pulses?

- (a) U.S.A. (b) China
(c) England (d) India

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (d)

Among the given options, a major producer and consumer of pulses is India. According to Agricultural Statistics at a Glance 2020. India is the largest producer of Pulses in the world, followed by Myanmar and Canada.

3. Which among the following products is not usually exported from India?

- (a) Wheat (b) Rice
(c) Sugar (d) Pulses

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

India has to import pulses despite being a leading producer due to the high rate of consumption. Thus, pulses are generally not exported from India whereas wheat, rice and sugar are exported at times.

4. India is the largest producer as well as the largest consumer and importer of which of the following crops?

- (a) Wheat (b) Cotton
(c) Pulses (d) Sugarcane

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

India is the largest (in 2023) producer, consumer and importer of pulses. These pulses are Chickpeas (known as gram or chanas), lentils (masoor dal), pigeon peas (arhar or toor dal) etc.

5. Assertion (A) : India has a shortage of pulses, but not of protein.

Reason (R) : There is a priority in demand of pulses.

In the reference of the above, which of the following is correct :

- (a) (A) and (R) both are correct, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) (A) and (R) both are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(c) (A) is correct, but (R) is wrong
(d) (A) is wrong , but (R) is correct

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

India has a shortage of pulses but there is no shortage of sources of protein. In India shortage of pulses is due to the high demand although India is a leading producer of pulses in the world. Therefore, both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

6. The largest pulses producing state in India -

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Bihar
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Rajasthan

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

When the question was asked option (c) was correct answer. According to the data of Economic Survey 2024-25, in the year 2023-24, the largest producer of pulses in India is Madhya Pradesh.

7. The type of crop which is able to fix nitrogen from the air is :

- (a) Wheat (b) Legumes

(c) Coffee

(d) Rubber

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

Legumes are quite unique among other crops as they draw their nitrogen from the air with the help of a specialized bacteria. So they do not require the same application of nitrogen fertilizer like other crops.

8. Which nutrient is considered essential for growing pulse crop ?

(a) Chromium

(b) Cobalt

(c) Iodine

(d) Sodium

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

Cobalt is known to be essential for symbiotic nitrogen fixation by Rhizobium. Cobalt is also needed in the synthesis of vitamin B₁₂. It is necessary for growth, photosynthesis and evaporation. Rhizobium is a bacterium found in the crops of pulses.

9. Which of the following is not correctly matched ?

(a) Arhar

- Neelam

(b) Groundnut

- Chandra

(c) Lentil

- Pant L - 406

(d) Mustard

- Varuna

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

Neelam is not a variety of Arhar crop it is a variety of Mango. Rest other options are correctly matched.

10. Pulse crop which does not fix atmospheric nitrogen is

(a) Gram

(b) Pea

(c) Rajma

(d) Moong

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (*)

Gram, Pea and Moong have the capacity of nitrogen fixation in the atmosphere. While it would not be correct to say that Rajma does not do nitrogen fixation at all. According to different research, the nitrogen fixation capacity of Rajma varies. Ref : **Scientific World Vol.9 No. 9 July, 2011**- Red Kidney bean (*Phaseolus Vulgari*.) a kind of annual leguminous crop, native to China is locally called Rajma in Nepal. It is cultivated as a crop or intercropped with other crops. It is also nitrogen-fixing crop with the symbiosis of Rhizobium. **Ali and Lal 1992**- Unlike other pulses rajma is inefficient in symbiotic nitrogen fixation. Nodulation is poor in rajma.

11. Balanced Fertilizers Ratio (NPK) for legume crops is –

(a) 1 : 2 : 2

(b) 3 : 2 : 1

(c) 4 : 2 : 1

(d) 2 : 2 : 1

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a)

Different crops demand soil nutrients in different proportions. For example, legumes (pulses) may need nutrients in a ratio of 0:1:1, 1:2:2, or 1:2:3. Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.

12. The place of origin of red gram is –

(a) America

(b) India

(c) South Africa

(d) Egypt

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

Major legume crop-red gram (arahar) originated in India.

13. Malaviya Chamatkar is a variety of –

(a) Pea

(b) Pigeon-Pea (Arhar)

(c) Moong

(d) Wheat

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

Malaviya Chamatkar is a variety of Arhar. Other main varieties of Arhar are Amar, Azad, Malaviya Vikas, Paras and Bahar.

14. Which of the following is correctly matched ?

(a) Arhar

- Bahar

(b) Barley

- PVW 343

(c) Gram

- Aparna

(d) Paddy

- NW 1014

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. 'Bahar' is a popular variety of –

(a) Pea

(b) Groundnut

(c) Pigeon pea

(d) Gram

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

16. The leafless variety of pea is –

(a) Arkel

(b) Azad Pea-I

(c) Aparna

(d) L-116

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

'Aparna' is a new high-yielding, leafless variety of pea.